

SONNY STEELE

Director of UX | Principal AI/ML Product Designer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

UX design leader with 20+ years designing and leading AI/ML product experiences that drive measurable business outcomes. Specialized in transforming complex machine learning systems into intuitive, user-centered interfaces for enterprise users — from conversational AI platforms processing 50M+ monthly interactions to ML model-training tools that cut setup time from 3 weeks to 2 days. Track record of \$60M+ combined revenue impact, 35% platform adoption gains, and 92% system failure prevention across AI, healthcare, and e-commerce. Expert at 0-to-1 product design, scaling high-performing design teams, establishing design systems, and navigating HIPAA/FDA/WCAG regulatory requirements.

IMPACT AT A GLANCE

- \$60M+ combined revenue impact and cost savings across AI, healthcare, e-commerce, and enterprise platforms
- 50M+ monthly users served across AI/ML products — conversational AI for Fortune 500 financial institutions
- 35% platform adoption increase (Kasisto) · 5% conversion lift = \$6M revenue (FCP Euro) · 40% decision speed gain (HealthCare.com)
- 92% system failure prevention rate through anomaly detection UI design at Ottermon AI
- FDA 510(k)-compliant medical device interfaces and HIPAA-compliant enterprise healthcare platforms
- Built UX functions from zero at multiple organizations; led 20+ cross-functional teams across the full design lifecycle

CORE COMPETENCIES

AI/ML UX Design: Conversational AI systems, AI assistants, ML-assisted recommendation systems, ML training UIs, anomaly detection systems, AI-powered analytics dashboards, prompt/response UX

Leadership & Strategy: 0-to-1 product design, product strategy, team building & scaling, design org strategy, roadmap ownership, OKR-aligned execution, DesignOps, stakeholder management, Agile/Scrum

Design Execution: Figma (advanced: tokens, variants, auto-layout, prototyping), design systems, wireframing, interaction design, information architecture, user-centered design, accessibility, WCAG/ADA

Research & Validation: User research, usability testing (UserTesting, Maze), design thinking, large dataset visualization, analytics dashboard design

Regulatory: HIPAA, FDA 510(k) UX compliance, WCAG/ADA enterprise standards, financial services regulatory UX

AI Tools: ChatGPT/GPT-4, Claude, Midjourney, Adobe Firefly, Notion AI, Perplexity AI

SKILLS

- Advanced Figma: Component Libraries, Auto-Layout, Variants, Design Tokens, Prototyping & Interactive User Flows
- Design Systems Strategy, Implementation & Governance
- Conversational AI Systems, AI Assistants & ML-Assisted Recommendation Engines
- Interaction Design & Information Architecture
- Mobile Design & Responsive/Adaptive Interfaces
- Accessibility Auditing & Inclusive Design (WCAG 2.1 AA)
- Data Visualization & Dashboard Design for Large-Scale Datasets

- User Research, Usability Testing & Design Thinking Facilitation
- Cross-Functional Collaboration (Engineering, Product, Data Science)
- Agile/Scrum Workflows, Sprint Planning & JIRA
- Product Strategy, Roadmap Development & OKR Alignment

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Self-Employed — UX Design Director & Principal AI/ML Consultant Jan 2024 – Present

Director-level UX engagements for enterprise AI companies requiring specialized leadership for ML-powered platforms. Defined UX strategy, owned design roadmaps, and drove OKR-aligned outcomes across client organizations.

Humanyze — Principal AI Designer

Aug 2025 – Jan 2026

Enterprise social media competitive intelligence platform serving marketing directors and C-suite at Fortune 500 brands.

- Redesigned core analytics interface and data visualization strategy, transforming millions of social data points into executive-ready competitive insights
- Created sentiment analysis dashboards that reduced executive decision-making time by streamlining competitive analysis workflows; findings presented directly to C-suite
- Built comprehensive component library and design system, establishing scalable UX standards and reducing design-to-dev handoff time

Kasisto — Head of UX Design

Jan 2025 – Jul 2025

Enterprise conversational AI platform powering digital assistants for Fortune 500 financial institutions handling 50M+ monthly customer interactions across 3 product lines.

- Drove 35% platform adoption increase by owning end-to-end UX roadmap across 3 product lines — including conversational AI systems, AI assistant experiences, and ML-assisted recommendation features — with stakeholder alignment, design strategy, and cross-functional execution
- Reduced ML model setup time from 3 weeks to 2 days by redesigning training interfaces to empower non-technical banking professionals; presented ROI case to executive leadership
- Built real-time analytics dashboards and ML-assisted recommendation systems supporting performance optimization across 200+ use cases for Fortune 500 banking clients
- Defined UX team processes and mentored junior designers in AI/ML UX principles, increasing team velocity and output quality

Ottermon AI — Lead UX Designer, AI Monitoring

Jan 2024 – Jan 2025

Enterprise AI monitoring platform for infrastructure and DevOps teams. Designed UX for anomaly detection and predictive failure systems across 15+ infrastructure modules.

- Designed anomaly detection UI that prevented 92% of system failures pre-impact, delivering measurable uptime improvements for enterprise clients
- Built analytics dashboards that reduced mean time to resolution (MTTR) by 50% through actionable data visualization
- Owned design system strategy supporting 15+ infrastructure modules, establishing unified UX patterns and scalable component governance
- Partnered with ML engineers to design model training interfaces and ML-assisted recommendation and prediction systems for custom anomaly detection algorithms
- Conducted user research with DevOps professionals to map workflow pain points and reduce context switching

HealthCare.com — Senior UX Manager

2022 – 2024

AI-powered healthcare platform matching users with health and supplemental insurance using ML-driven personalization and real-time health scoring.

- Improved decision speed by 40% and lowered user costs by 25% by leading design of an AI-driven healthcare recommendation platform
- Designed ML-powered health scoring and analytics dashboards that transformed raw health data into preventive, strategic insights
- Increased user engagement with preventive care by 35% through predictive health scoring interfaces identifying risks and recommending interventions

- Designed HIPAA-compliant UX across cost tracking, benefit optimization, and AI health scoring — enabling enterprise adoption while maintaining regulatory integrity

FCP Euro — Senior UX Director

2020 - 2022

Premier e-commerce platform serving European car enthusiasts with 350,000+ genuine and performance parts. Built the UX function from the ground up.

- Generated \$6M in additional annual revenue through a 5% conversion rate increase achieved in 3 months — result of a ground-up redesign of the parts-finding experience
- Reduced support call volume by 45% through strategic UI improvements informed by call center analytics
- Built and scaled the UX team from zero, establishing data-driven design processes, tooling, and standards across the organization

Wayfair — Senior UX Design Manager

2018 - 2020

Led UX strategy for CastleGate, Wayfair's \$2B+ logistics platform managing ocean freight, drayage, and last-mile delivery for furniture and home goods.

- Saved \$16M in operational costs by leading system design that reduced supplier time-on-task by 8 hours daily across thousands of active suppliers
- Reduced customer success manager time-on-task by 18 hours weekly through information architecture optimization
- Managed 5 cross-functional work stream pods — each comprising 3 designers, 1 content writer, and 1 PM; mentored 2 employees off performance improvement plans

Hexaware Technologies — Principal UX Designer

2011 - 2018

UX design lead for Fortune 500 enterprise clients across healthcare, retail, fitness, and media.

- Increased Panera Bread mobile orders by 40% by designing a menu navigation and customization experience optimized for mobile-first ordering
- Designed UPMC healthcare platform improving patient care workflows and medical data integration for clinical staff
- Created Weight Watchers wellness platform supporting millions of users with personalized nutrition tracking and community engagement
- Built platforms for Wawa, Comcast Tech Nucleus, Reebok ONE, and Weather Channel — spanning retail POS, enterprise tech, fitness wearables, and media

TOOLS & PLATFORMS

Figma (advanced) • UserTesting • Maze • JIRA • Trello • Adobe Creative Suite • ChatGPT/GPT-4 • Claude • Midjourney • Adobe Firefly • Notion AI • Perplexity AI